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Navigating gender-related challenges?



Sumati Sahgal, Lenovo

There will be team members who may want to push you around or overrule a decision. I remember an instance where a woman employee was not even asked to join a meeting, assuming that she would be unavailable. You have to go out and make the effort initially to be seen as someone willing to go the extra mile as any other person. Women need to be assertive and not worry about being seen as aggressive.



Kaveri Jain, Micron

In the 90s, the industry had moderate representation of women in the engineering teams, and I found that I was often the only female voice in the room. Overcoming my own inhibitions and being over-prepared and detail-oriented helped me gain the respect of my peers. Mentorship played a key role in the early days, finding and building relationships with people who will give you perspective and context is the single most important aspect of early-stage career success.



Snehal Meshram, Amazon

It's crucial to sensitise and educate all members equally on bias-related topics, including the leadership. Navigating through these challenges is not just the responsibility of the members who are facing the bias, leaders in tech companies are all responsible to ensure a fair and balanced workplace where all members have a level-playing field and feel that they have similar opportunities to develop and grow.



Jaya Singh, Texas Instruments

Sharpen your skills and core competencies by taking on new challenges, and step out of your comfort zone to do things that don't come easily to you. I feel the assignments that challenged me were the ones that taught me the most. I also feel that women need to be ambitious and seek higher technical or management positions.



Jaya Jagadish, AMD

As a young engineering student in the 90s, one of my professors told me that "I am wasting a man's seat in the tech industry" as I will soon give up my career. I fought this bias, tooth and nail. Often women aren't as vocal and aggressive when it comes to asking for pay hikes or bringing up concerns on disparities at work. Building awareness on this will help address this issue at an industry level.